STEPHEN GIFT
MUKOYA ARAKA

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LinkedIn | Github | Portfolio

CAREER SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience building scalable web and mobile applications across Africa, Europe, and the U.S. Proven track record delivering high-performance products using React, React Native, Node.js, and cloud-native technologies.

Reduced bandwidth usage by 40% on a cloud platform and improved platform performance by 15%+ in production systems.

Strong experience working in distributed global teams, with a focus on performance optimization, user experience, and scalable architecture.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6), Tailwind CSS
Backend: Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, WebSockets
Mobile: React Native, Expo
Cloud & DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, GCP, CI/CD (CircleCI, Jenkins), Terraform
Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL
Tools: Git, Jira, Agile (Scrum/Kanban), Figma

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University – Africa, Rwanda Aug 2020 – Dec 2022
Master of Science in Information Technology CGPA 3.35
Department of Information and Communication Technology

Makerere University – Uganda Aug 2016 – May 2019
Bachelor of Science Computer Science CGPA 3.92
College of Computing and Information Science

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mobile Software Engineer II – Full time June 2025 – Jan 2026
Jumba – Kenya

- Developed key features for a logistics SaaS mobile platform improving delivery workflows
- Enhanced application reliability and user experience for construction supply chain users
- Contributed to scaling platform used by contractors and transporters across Kenya

Software Developer Consultant – Part time Jan 2025 – Present

Sergeant Solutions – Kenya

- Built cross-platform applications using **Next.js and React Native**
- Delivered production-ready client solutions from development to deployment
- Supported multiple client projects across frontend and mobile stacks

Full stack Software Engineer – Contract Jul 2022 – Dec 2024

atlasGO – San Francisco, U.S | teroGO – Belgium

- Led end-to-end development of a mobile well-being app
- Increased monthly active users by **20%**
- Collaborated remotely with international teams across multiple time zones
- Built scalable backend services using Node.js

Frontend Engineer – Full time Jul 2022 – Sep 2023

Jumia – Kenya

- Built and optimized vendor platform interfaces using Angular and JavaScript
- Reduced platform load time by 15%
- Migrated users from legacy system to modern architecture
- Improved UI/UX for thousands of vendors

Graduate Teaching Assistant – Software Architecture and Design Jan 2022 – May 2022

Carnegie Mellon University, Africa – Rwanda

- Currently coordinating a class of 14 students to develop skills in designing, developing, and justifying reasonable software architecture for enterprise-scale software-intensive systems, considering both functional and non-functional requirements as well as contextual system environments.
- Organising recitations, assignments, and discussions to accord students a smooth transition in Software Architecture and Design.

Graduate Teaching Assistant – First Year Seminar Aug 2021 – Dec 2021

Carnegie Mellon University, Africa – Rwanda

- Assisted a class of 48 students in developing students' career skills and broadening professional horizons through exposure to a wide-ranging set of issues in ICT.

DevOps Engineer – Intern Jun 2021 – Sep 2021

Crane Cloud – Uganda

- Analysed current containerization processes used by Crane Cloud users.
- Researched on containerization best practices drawn from industry.
- Implemented and tested initial version of a Docker containerization pipeline for over 200 users – link to github repo.

Software Engineer Apr 2019 – Dec 2020

Crane Cloud – Uganda

- Built **cranecloud.io**, a cloud infrastructure platform
- Reduced developer bandwidth usage by **40%**
- Contributed to open-source cloud-native tooling adoption

Software Developer Nov 2019 – Jan 2020

REF. Sports Limited – Uganda

- Cemented company’s online presence through designing and building an e-commerce website.

Software Developer Jan 2019 – Mar 2019

Line23 – Uganda

- Executed the implementation of a mobile application to aid team collaboration.

Developer Consultant – Intern Jun 2018 – Sep 2018

Flock of Birds – Uganda

- Developed widgets for Mendix, a low-code software platform to build, test, deploy and iterate applications, by working with fellow interns.
- Gained hands-on experience in software development and consultancy through engaging and helping customers with questions about company products and services.
- Selected among 8 interns and retained to work as permanent staff.

PROJECTS

- ZURI GAS – Developed a secure web platform that enables users around Nairobi to verify authenticity and safely purchase cooking gas online, enhancing trust and convenience in the supply chain – link to website **[2025 - Freelance Project]**
- SMART BUILD AI – Built a smart budget estimation platform that leverages AI to provide accurate construction cost forecasts for contractors, architects, and individual homeowners - link to website **[2025 - Freelance Project]**
- EVENTLY – Designed and implemented a mobile app for discovering and booking events, focusing on intuitive navigation and seamless user engagement. **[2025 - Hobby Project]**
- WISDOM – Created a mobile app delivering daily wisdom quotes through a clean, minimal interface to promote positivity and reflection. **[2024 - Hobby Project]**
- (React, Node.js, MongoDB, Tailwind CSS)Estimation of carbon emission reduction from forestry and farming for carbon credits trading (React Native, Node.js) **[Jan 2022 - School Project]**
- Online pet shop and veterinary service (React, Node.js, MongoDB) – link to website **[Dec 2021 - Hobby Project]**.
- COAST - End-to-end AI and data systems for targeted surveillance and management of COVID-19 and future pandemics affecting Uganda (HTML, CSS) **[Dec 2021 - Hobby Project]**
- High performance Twitter Analytics Web Service on the cloud (Terraform, Kubernetes, Helm, AWS, GCP, Azure, Microservices) **[Sep 2021 – Dec 2021 - School Project]**

HONOURS AND AWARDS

- Recognized for volunteering as a Mastercard Foundation facilitator for a bootcamp to teach programming basics to students using Python (2021).
- Recipient of a full scholarship from the Mastercard Foundation for the master's program at Carnegie Mellon University Africa (2020).
- Recognized for volunteering as an organiser for the Bright Summer School at Makerere University to enhance ICT Training and Research in Uganda (2017).

ADDITIONAL

Remote collaboration experience (US, Europe, Africa)
Open to relocation or remote roles
Strong problem-solving and system design skills